One ID per pupil: joining sheets

Data engineering · Level 2 · Lesson 4



Today we will

- Give every pupil one ID.
- Join two sheets by ID, not by name.
- Find and question the rows with no match.

Remember

- Names make poor keys; an ID means one pupil.
- A lookup joins sheets by their key.
- A missing match is a question, not rubbish.

Human join

1. Warm-up (5 min): Match these marks by name.
2. Teach (8 min): Keys and lookups.
3. Join (12 min): Find your partner by number.
4. Question (10 min): Who’s left, and why?
5. Wrap-up (5 min): The same join on a computer.

Prepare the cards before the lesson: one pupil with no mark, one mark with an unknown number and one pupil with two marks. Use made-up names, and keep the number cards so you can reuse them.

Let’s discuss

1. Why do names make poor keys?
2. What could a mark with no pupil mean?
3. Why did one pupil appear twice?

Exit ticket

- Write what a key is in one sentence, and one reason a row might have no match.